

CHENG, KA YAN

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EDUCATION

Emory University

Doctor of Philosophy in Economics Aug 2021 – Jul 2027 (Expected)
Dissertation committee: Zheng Fang (chair)
Florian Gunsilius, Alejandro Sánchez-Becerra, Pedro H. C. Sant'Anna

The Chinese University of Hong Kong (CUHK)

Master of Philosophy in Economics Aug 2019 – Jul 2021
Advisor: Zhentao Shi

Bachelor of Social Science in Economics, First Class Honours Sep 2015 – Jul 2019
Minor: Statistics, Concentration Area: Financial Economics

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Econometric theory, machine learning, semiparametric estimation

PUBLICATIONS

“Survey-Based Forecasting: To Average or Not to Average” with Naijing Huang and Zhentao Shi.
In *Behavioral Predictive Modeling in Economics* (Studies in Computational Intelligence, vol. 897), Springer, 2021, pp. 87–104.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor – Department of Economics, Emory University

ECON 320: Econometrics (Lab) (UG)

Teaching Assistant – Department of Economics, Emory University

ECON 722: Time Series Econometrics (PhD)
ECON 622: Econometric Methods II (PhD)
ECON 620: Probability Theory and Statistical Inference (PhD)
ECON 543: Cost-Benefit Analysis (Master's)
ECON 524: Big Data Econometrics (Master's)
ECON 320: Econometrics (UG)
ECON 220: Data Science for Economists (UG)

Teaching Assistant – Department of Economics, The Chinese University of Hong Kong

ECON 4470: Economics of Behavioral Finance (UG)
ECON 4130: Economic Analysis for Social Networks (UG)
ECON 1101: Mathematical Methods in Economics I (UG)

RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Department of Economics, Emory University, Atlanta, GA

Research Assistant to Esfandiar Maasoumi Spring 2026
Research Assistant to Melvin Ayogu Spring 2025
Research Assistant to Ian McCarthy Fall 2022

Department of Economics, The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Hong Kong

Research Assistant to Zhentao Shi Sep 2017 – Jul 2021

Banking Supervision Department, Hong Kong Monetary Authority, Hong Kong

Summer Intern Jun 2018 – Aug 2018

REFeree SERVICE

Empirical Economics, ICML

OTHER SKILLS

Languages

Native in Cantonese
Fluent in English and Mandarin

Programming skills

R, Python, Stata, MATLAB